

Student Journey

Feature Specification & User Stories

Ethical Yoga App

Internal Document • March 2026

Draft for Review

Overview

This document maps the complete student journey from first discovery to ongoing use. The student experience is intentionally simple — the complexity of the platform lives on the teacher side. For the student, this should feel like a familiar booking app with one meaningful difference: the pricing is fair and transparent.

Students don't come to the platform on their own. They arrive because a teacher they know shared a link. There is no marketplace, no discovery, no browsing. The relationship starts with trust — trust in a teacher — and the platform supports that relationship without inserting itself.

The journey follows four phases:

- 1. Discovery & First Booking** — Landing on a teacher's page, booking a class, creating an account
- 2. Pre-Class** — Managing bookings, understanding pricing, handling cancellations
- 3. After Class** — Being charged, seeing the pricing breakdown, receiving notifications
- 4. Ongoing Use** — Managing account, privacy settings, attendance history, multiple teachers

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Discovery & First Booking

The student receives a link from their teacher — shared on Instagram, WhatsApp, email, or in person. They land on the teacher's personal page. This is their first encounter with the platform, and it should feel immediately familiar: a booking page with a schedule, not a philosophical statement. The ethics of the platform reveal themselves during the booking process, not before it.

Teacher's Personal Page

As a **new student**, I want to **visit my teacher's page and see their upcoming classes**, so that **I can find and book a class**.

- ✓ Page shows teacher's name, profile picture, and short description
- ✓ Upcoming classes are listed with date, time, duration, location, and class type

- ✓ Each class shows available spots (or “waitlist” if full)
- ✓ Page looks and feels like a standard booking app — no learning curve
- ✓ Page is accessible via the platform URL (app.com/teachername) or the teacher’s custom domain

Booking & Account Creation

When a new student selects a class, account creation happens inline as part of the booking flow. There is no separate sign-up step. The student provides the minimum information needed to complete the booking and enters the system.

As a **new student**, I want to **book a class and create my account in one flow**, so that **I don’t have to sign up separately before I can book**.

- ✓ Student selects a class and is guided through account creation as part of booking
- ✓ Required fields: first name, last name, email address, payment method
- ✓ Only first name + last initial is ever shown to teachers
- ✓ Account creation and first booking are completed in a single flow
- ✓ Student receives a confirmation email with booking details

Income Tier Selection

This is the one moment where the platform’s philosophy becomes visible to the student. After entering their basic information, the student is asked to select their income tier. This step is framed warmly and briefly, with a short explanation of why it matters and a quote from yogic philosophy. A link is available for students who want to understand the full system.

As a **new student**, I want to **select my income tier with a clear and non-judgmental explanation**, so that **I understand why I’m being asked and can make an honest choice**.

- ✓ Income tier selection is presented with a brief, warm explanation (1–2 sentences)
- ✓ A yogic philosophy quote accompanies the selection (e.g., on Satya/truthfulness)
- ✓ A “Learn more” link is available for students who want to understand the pricing model
- ✓ Tiers are described in accessible, non-judgmental language — not salary brackets
- ✓ 3 to 5 tiers are available (exact number TBD, leaning toward 5)
- ✓ Selection is self-reported with no verification
- ✓ Income tier is set once and applies globally across all teachers

- ✓ The tone is inviting, not guilt-inducing — an invitation to reflect, not a moral test

The income tier selection is the most philosophically important screen in the entire application. It must strike the balance between being meaningful and being effortless. Too much text and it becomes a lecture. Too little and the student clicks through without thinking. The yogic quote is the anchor — it signals that this question is asked with intention, not as a transaction.

Returning Student Booking

As a **returning student**, I want to **book a class with any teacher using my existing account**, so that **I don't need to create a new account for each teacher**.

- ✓ Student logs in with their existing account
- ✓ All previously entered information (name, payment method, income tier) is reused
- ✓ Booking is completed in one or two clicks
- ✓ Student can book with any teacher on the platform — one account, multiple teachers

Open Questions

- ? Should returning students be able to book without logging in (e.g., via a magic link from email)?
- ? How is the income tier selection phrased? What are the exact tier labels?
- ? Which yogic quote(s) are used? Should they rotate or stay fixed?

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Pre-Class

After booking, the student enters a waiting period before class. During this time they need clear information: when and where is the class, what's the estimated price, and what are the rules around cancellation. The system should be informative without being noisy.

Upcoming Bookings

As a **student**, I want to **see all my upcoming bookings in one place**, so that **I can keep track of my schedule across all teachers**.

- ✓ Upcoming bookings screen shows all booked classes across all teachers

- ✓ Each booking shows: teacher name, class type, date, time, location
- ✓ Each booking shows the estimated price range based on the student's tier and the class's min/max student count
- ✓ Student can filter bookings by teacher
- ✓ Bookings are sorted chronologically

As a **student**, I want to **see the cancellation deadline clearly for each booking**, so that **I know when I can still cancel without being charged**.

- ✓ Each booking prominently displays the cancellation deadline (date and time)
- ✓ A visual indicator shows whether the cancellation window is still open
- ✓ After the deadline passes, the booking is marked as "locked in"

Cancellation

As a **student**, I want to **cancel a booking before the cancellation deadline**, so that **I'm not charged for a class I can't attend**.

- ✓ Student can cancel directly from the upcoming bookings screen
- ✓ Cancellation before the deadline is free — no charge, removed from the class
- ✓ Student receives confirmation of cancellation
- ✓ If the class had a waitlist, the next student is automatically moved in

As a **student**, I want to **understand what happens if I cancel late or don't show up**, so that **there are no surprises about being charged**.

- ✓ The cancellation policy is clearly explained during booking and visible on the booking detail screen
- ✓ Late cancellation: student is charged their share as if they attended
- ✓ No-show: same as late cancellation — charged their share
- ✓ No-shows receive a friendly "We missed you today" notification, not a punitive message

Class Confirmation & Auto-Cancel

As a **student**, I want to **be notified if my class is auto-cancelled due to low attendance**, so that **I don't show up to a class that isn't happening**.

- ✓ If the auto-cancel check determines the class is below minimum, all students are notified

- ✓ Notification is sent at the auto-cancel time (4h, 2h, or 1h before class, depending on teacher setting)
- ✓ No charges are applied for an auto-cancelled class
- ✓ The cancelled class is removed from the student's upcoming bookings

As a **student**, I want to **join a waitlist when a class is full**, so that **I still have a chance to attend if someone cancels**.

- ✓ When a class is at maximum capacity, the student can join the waitlist
- ✓ Waitlist position is shown to the student
- ✓ If a spot opens up (someone cancels before the deadline), the first waitlisted student is automatically moved in
- ✓ Student is notified immediately when moved from waitlist to confirmed
- ✓ If moved in after the cancellation deadline, the student is locked in (cannot cancel)
- ✓ Student can remove themselves from the waitlist at any time before being moved in

Open Questions

- ? Should the student receive a reminder notification before class (e.g., morning of, 1 hour before)?
- ? If a waitlisted student is moved in and can't make it, is there any recourse?

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After Class

After class, the student is charged. This is the moment where the income-based pricing model becomes real for the student — they see their individual price and can understand how it was calculated. Transparency is key: the student should never feel surprised by a charge, and should be able to see exactly where their money went.

Pricing & Payment

As a **student**, I want to **see my final price after class with a clear explanation**, so that **I understand what I'm paying and why**.

- ✓ Student receives a notification after class with their final price
- ✓ Price is shown prominently and clearly
- ✓ An expandable "See pricing breakdown" section shows full transparency
- ✓ Student is charged automatically via their payment method on file

Pricing Breakdown

The pricing breakdown is available to any student who wants to understand how their price was calculated. It is not forced on the student — the primary view shows just their price. The breakdown is one tap away for the curious.

The breakdown shows:

Your price: €9.00 (always prominent, always first)

Expandable breakdown:

Room cost: €50.00

Teacher earnings: €45.00

Students in class: 12

Average price per student: €7.92

Your tier adjustment: +€1.08 (your tier contributes slightly more to keep prices fair for everyone)

The breakdown deliberately uses plain language rather than showing tier ratios or percentages. The student sees the economics of the class, understands their contribution, and can see that the teacher's earnings and the room cost are real, transparent numbers.

Payment Notifications

As a **student**, I want to **receive a clear notification when I'm charged**, so that **I'm never surprised by a payment**.

- ✓ Post-class payment notification shows the amount, the class, and the teacher
- ✓ Notification links to the full pricing breakdown
- ✓ Payment appears in the student's payment history

As a **student**, I want to **see my full payment history**, so that **I can track what I've spent across all classes and teachers**.

- ✓ Payment history shows all charges with date, teacher, class, and amount
- ✓ History can be filtered by teacher or time period

- ✓ Total spent per month is visible
- ✓ Each payment links to the pricing breakdown for that class

No-Show Notification

As a **student who missed a class**, I want to **receive a friendly notification rather than a punitive one**, so that **I feel welcomed back, not scolded**.

- ✓ No-show notification is warm and brief (“We missed you today”)
- ✓ Notification includes the charge (same as if they attended)
- ✓ Notification includes a link to the teacher’s upcoming classes to rebook
- ✓ Tone is caring, not transactional or accusatory

Open Questions

- ? Should the breakdown show the number of students per tier, or just the total student count?
- ? How is the “tier adjustment” framed for students in lower tiers (who pay less than average)?
- ? Should students see a monthly summary email or only per-class notifications?

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Ongoing Use

Over time, the student builds a relationship with one or more teachers through the platform. The ongoing experience is about managing their account, adjusting settings, and maintaining their practice. The app stays quiet and useful — a utility, not a destination.

Home Screen

As a **student**, I want to **see my upcoming classes as the default home view**, so that **I immediately know what’s next**.

- ✓ Home screen shows upcoming booked classes across all teachers
- ✓ Classes are shown chronologically with key details (teacher, type, time, location)
- ✓ Estimated or confirmed price is visible per class
- ✓ Student can filter by teacher to focus on one teacher’s schedule
- ✓ Student can deselect/hide past teachers they no longer practice with

Multiple Teachers

As a **student**, I want to **book with a new teacher using my existing account**, so that **I can expand my practice without any friction**.

- ✓ When a student visits a new teacher's page and books, the teacher is automatically added to their teacher list
- ✓ No additional account setup is needed — existing income tier, payment method, and profile are reused
- ✓ Student's home screen now includes classes from the new teacher
- ✓ Privacy settings default to maximum privacy for the new teacher

As a **student**, I want to **filter and manage my list of teachers**, so that **I only see classes from teachers I'm currently practicing with**.

- ✓ Student can view a list of all teachers they've booked with
- ✓ Student can hide or deselect teachers they no longer practice with
- ✓ Hidden teachers can be restored at any time
- ✓ Filtering applies to the home screen and upcoming bookings view

Privacy Settings

As a **student**, I want to **control what personal information each teacher can see about me**, so that **I share more with teachers I trust and less with new ones**.

- ✓ Global default is maximum privacy: only first name + last initial is visible
- ✓ Student can override privacy settings per teacher
- ✓ Optional fields that can be shared per teacher: email, phone, health/injury notes, experience level
- ✓ Changes take effect immediately
- ✓ Individual income tier is never visible to any teacher (system-level rule)

The per-teacher privacy model mirrors how trust works in real life. A student who's been practicing with a teacher for six months might share their email and health notes. A teacher they just tried once sees only the minimum. The system supports the natural deepening of the relationship.

Income Tier Management

As a **student**, I want to **change my income tier if my financial situation changes**, so that **my pricing reflects my current ability to contribute**.

- ✓ Student can access and change their income tier from account settings
- ✓ Change applies to all future bookings across all teachers
- ✓ The same warm framing and yogic quote from initial selection is present
- ✓ Previous tier history is not visible to teachers

Open Questions

- ? Should there be a cooldown period on tier changes (e.g., once every 3 months) to prevent gaming?
- ? Should the student see their own attendance statistics (classes per week, streaks)?
- ? Is there value in showing the student how their consistent attendance has lowered average class prices?

Design Principles for the Student Experience

Familiar first, different second. The booking experience should feel like every other booking app the student has used. The income-based pricing and ethical framing are meaningful, but they're details within a familiar flow — not barriers to entry.

Show the price, explain on request. The student's price is always prominent. The full breakdown (room cost, teacher earnings, tier adjustment) is one tap away but never forced. Transparency is available, not imposed.

One account, zero friction. The student creates one account, sets their income tier once, and that's it. Every subsequent booking with any teacher is fast and effortless. No re-entering information, no new sign-ups.

Quiet utility. The app is a tool, not a destination. No social features, no engagement tricks, no notifications beyond what's necessary. The student opens the app when they need it and puts it away when they don't.

Warm, never punitive. Late cancellations and no-shows have financial consequences (you pay your share), but the communication is always warm. “We missed you today” — not “You were charged for missing class.”

Trust by default. Income is self-reported. Privacy is maximum by default. The system assumes the best of people and designs for that assumption. This is the ethical core of the product, expressed in every interaction.